



Plants for pastel colors

Romantic and feminine, a planting scheme of pinks, purples, peaches, and custard-yellows produces a calming effect in the garden.

These easy-on-the-eye shades are much sought-after and you will find a wide variety of plants to suit such a scheme. The only danger is that designs made up exclusively of soft shades can look rather bland, so to balance the pale hues add a few high- and lowlights, such as bright pinks and dark burgundy. A sprinkling of small white blooms will also lighten subdued pastel schemes. In addition, lift the focus to eye level and above by planting climbers, such as a pink climbing rose or an elegant purple clematis. Use foliage plants like coral bells, New Zealand flax, and stonecrop for long-lasting color.



SHRUB LARGE

Abutilon hybrids

FLOWERING MAPLE These upright deciduous shrubs have narrow, lobed, felted gray-green foliage. From late spring to early summer, they produce flowers in many soft tones. Suitable as an annual in colder areas.

↑12ft (4m) ↔8ft (2.5m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z9-10



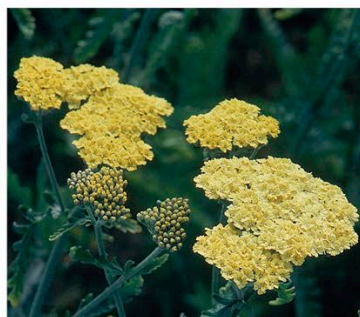
TREE LARGE

Acer negundo

BOXELDER This tree has lobed reddish brown young leaves that turn midgreen in summer. Grow the variety 'Flamingo' (above) for its white- and pink-variegated foliage, but remember that the leaves of all forms turn bright yellow in fall.

↑50ft (15m) ↔30ft (10m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3-8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Achillea 'Taygetea'

YARROW The combination of this perennial's feathery gray-green foliage and flat heads of pale yellow summer flowers give a subtle highlight in a pastel-themed bed or border. Plant it with purple and dark pink flower spikes in free-draining soil and full sun.

↑24in (60cm) ↔20in (50cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3-8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Agastache 'Black Adder'

HYSSOP Decorate sunny beds with this perennial's spikes of fluffy violet-purple flowers, which appear from late summer to mid-fall above slim green leaves. Use it with other pastels or to contrast with white or fiery shades.

↑24in (60cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z6-9



BULB MEDIUM

Allium cristophii

STARS OF PERSIA Prized for its large spherical heads of star-shaped violet flowers in early summer, this bulb also forms decorative seedheads, providing a long season of interest. The narrow gray-green leaves fade as the flowers appear.

↑16in (40cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z5-8



BULB LARGE

Allium 'Purple Sensation'

FLOWERING ONION This perennial bulb offers globes of small purple flowers held aloft on sturdy stems in early summer. They are followed by decorative buff-colored seedheads. Disguise the strap-shaped leaves, which fade as the flowers appear.

↑32in (80cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3-8



BULB MEDIUM

Allium senescens

GERMAN GARLIC This early-summer-flowering bulb has short stems topped with spherical purple-pink flower heads that bloom for many weeks, and blue-green foliage. Plant it in fall. *A. senescens* subsp. *glaucum* has pale lilac flowers.

↑24in (60cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4-9